SPEAKER NATION

5 SIMPLE STEPS

TO CREATE A GREAT PRESENTATION

A proven strategy to follow so you're ready to present to any audience, from any stage or screen, at any time.

Even on last-minute notice.

PICTURE THIS

You have just received an email from the organizer of an event you are planning to attend in a few days. It seems one of their keynote speakers has fallen ill and is unable to present. The organizers are in need of an industry-leading expert to fill in, your name was mentioned in one of their meetings, and now they want YOU to come and speak!

You are excited as you think about what this could mean for your career. The opportunity to share your insights and prove your expertise to thousands of peers, the chance to position yourself as a leader in your industry, not to mention the financial benefits of such an opportunity. But that excitement quickly fades as you realize something devastating...

You're not a public speaker. You don't have a talk prepared. And you don't have nearly enough time to prepare one!

You're forced to turn down a career-making opportunity simply because you lacked the most valuable skill available to anyone in any industry: public speaking.

The good news is that you won't ever have to find yourself in that situation. The very fact that you downloaded this guide means you understand just how important it is to be an effective communicator and have the ability to share your message with the masses. Public speaking truly is one of the most powerful forms of influence available to you. Being an effective and powerful communicator will benefit every aspect of your life, from your career to your relationships.

"When I was terrified of public speaking, my life was one way. When I got over it and became comfortable, everything about my life completely transformed."

- Eric Edmeades, Speaker Nation Founder

One of the most important keys to successful public speaking is knowing what to say and, more importantly, having the ability to quickly create a talk that will engage your audience, is easy to remember (both for you and your audience), and effectively gets your message across every time.

In this guide, you will learn a proven framework—designed and used by Speaker Nation's founder Eric Edmeades—to easily create talks that will wow your audience, clearly make your point in a way the audience will remember, and can be adjusted to suit just about any situation.

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HOW TO GET THE MOST FROM THIS GUIDE

As with any informative document, if you were to simply read this text and think about it, you would likely get some value out of it. But we have found, through our experience working with hundreds of budding speakers over the years, that the real magic happens when you combine knowledge with action. Here are a few tips to help you get the most value out of this guide.

01 Go through each step as if it was an individual exercise. Even if you are just here for the information, imagine you are trying to create a new talk. In each step of the guide, take some time and actually do the step before you move on to reading the next one.

02 Spend extra time on step 2. Step 2 of this guide applies to so much more than just creating a new talk. As a speaker, coach, presenter, or service provider of any kind, having a well-catalogued inventory of stories and lessons from your own life is incredibly valuable. If you were to ignore everything in this guide except step 2, we think you would find your speaking still improves.

03 Practice and repeat. This guide gives you the tools you need to create one amazing talk, but why stop with one? Repetition is the secret to success, so once you have created one talk, we suggest you create another, and another, and another… The more you go through the steps and actually put them into practice, the better you will get at it, and the more you will find ways to tweak and adjust the formula to suit your personal creative flow.

04 Rehearse your stories. We generally don't recommend people rehearse entire talks; it's time consuming, repetitive and it can make a speech feel inauthentic to the audience. Instead, we recommend that you practice the individual stories you want to include in your talk. But don't just stand by a mirror and talk to yourself—get it out in public where you can get some feedback. Tell stories to your friends, family, and coworkers. Make online videos. Or our personal favorite way to practice: Join the **Speaker Nation public Facebook group**, post live videos of yourself telling your stories and ask the community for feedback!

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STEP 1 : DETERMINE YOUR STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES

Have you ever gone grocery shopping without a list? At best, you end up with a few of the things you wanted and a few things you probably didn't want, and most of the time you end up forgetting something important. At worst, you end up with none of the things you wanted in the first place. Creating a talk without first considering your strategic objectives is kind of the same.

Think of your strategic objectives as the shopping list for your talk.

Think of your strategic objectives as the shopping list for your talk. What do you ultimately want to achieve by taking the stage with your message? Having a clear understanding of this before you even start creating the talk gives you some direction when it comes time to pick your points and your stories for the talk itself.

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Get your primary objective down in writing so you have a clear understanding of the end goal before you even go on stage.

It could be:

- A specific concept you want to teach
- Making the audience laugh
- Selling a book
- Getting votes
- Or just making it through the talk without a slip up!

What is your ideal outcome? Be strategic about it; this is the whole reason you are giving the talk in the first place!

After you have determined your primary objective, it's time to look at your secondary objectives. This is the part that most speakers skip, and they miss many opportunities to get even more out of their talks because they haven't taken the time to think through their secondary objectives.

Your secondary objectives are things you would like to happen as a result of doing the talk, even if they aren't the main reason you are there.

Secondary objectives could be things like:

- Finding an agent to represent your new book
- Booking your next speaking gig
- Being invited as a guest on podcasts
- Increasing your social media following
- The list goes on!

Think of your secondary objectives as things that would be nice to get, although not completely necessary.

You have the power to make those secondary objectives happen based on the way you structure your talk. For example, if you're looking for a book agent, mention it subtly in your presentation so if there happens to be a book agent in the crowd, they know they should come meet you afterwards. Or if you are looking to get booked on more podcasts, tell a story about how much you enjoy doing podcast interviews and make it known that you want to do more of them so people in the audience who have podcasts know they should approach you.

Your secondary objectives will help you pick content that can help you get more out of the talk than just the primary outcome you are after.

What does your strategic outcome look like? **Fill out the worksheet below to get brainstorming on what you ultimately wish to accomplish by taking the stage with your signature talk.**

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STEP 1 : DETERMINE YOUR STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES

WATCH VIDEO: https://youtu.be/YFQVhSlIcR4

What are you trying to achieve? Sell a product or service? Get rebooked? Make the audience laugh?

NAME OF TALK: _____

Primary Objectives

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Secondary Objectives

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

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STEP 2 : CAPTURE YOUR STORIES

Stories are the programming language of the human brain. Long before written language existed, humans used stories to communicate knowledge and ideas from person to person and generation to generation. It is so deeply rooted in human development that it is still most people's preferred method of communication. Stories are so much a part of the human experience that most people even think and process complicated emotions by telling themselves stories. The best talks in history are nothing more than a bunch of stories that make a point.

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Life is made up of a series of stories. There is a story behind everything you have ever learned. There is a story behind every success and every failure. Anything that has ever happened that made you feel something is a story. Those stories from your life form the basis of every talk you will ever give.

So then, why is one of the most common things we hear from beginner speakers that they don't know what to say? It's not that they don't have stories to tell, it's just that they haven't learned to recognise the value in those stories and, more importantly, they don't yet have a system to document and organize those stories.

Don't rely on your memory! Create a story journal where you can document and tag your stories so when you need to create a talk you have an inventory of material to draw from. This will ensure your perfect story is there for you to recall whenever you need, rather than lost in your brain somewhere.

When documenting your stories, avoid writing them down word for word. Instead, use jot notes of the main points you remember to help you tell the full story. When a story is written out exactly as you'd like it to be told, it's too memorized and staged rather than being an actual memory. You want your talk to come across as genuine as possible. Remember, these are stories from your own life, so you don't need every single detail written out, you just need enough detail to jog your memories and keep important facts straight.

Once you have your stories, the notes, and quick titles to trigger the reference for you, begin tagging your stories with what themes they adhere to, or what points they could be used to make. This could include topics such as sales, successes, failures, important life lessons, funny stories, embarrassing stories… The list is endless. By tagging them, you can easily go back and review which stories will be effective for which talk.

Having a well-organized catalog of stories not only gives you a vast inventory to draw from when you need to create a talk, but it also trains your brain to notice the value of the stories in your life more readily. Many speakers report that after struggling to think of the first few stories for their story journals, something happens in their minds and they suddenly find they are noticing stories everywhere in their lives.

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STEP 2 : CAPTURE YOUR STORIES

WATCH VIDEO: https://youtu.be/187zJK0cRwE

Create a catalogue of stories so that you never have to rely on memory again.

STORY TITLE : _____ **Duration** _____

Bullet Points of Story	Speech Map of Story
• _____ • _____ • _____ • _____ • _____ • _____ • _____ • _____ • _____ • _____ • _____ • _____	

Topic Tags

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STEP 3 : F15 – YOUR POWERFUL OPENING

Just like an F15 fighter jet uses half of its fuel during take off, the first few minutes of any talk are where you should be putting in the most effort. Having a strong start will establish a connection with the audience, and set the tone for the rest of your talk.

The first few minutes of any talk are where you should be putting in the most effort.

You really have to be absolutely clear on the first few things you're going to say when you hit the stage. By developing a really strong start, you'll be so much more comfortable, calm and relaxed while you're speaking for the remainder of the presentation, because the beginning was so successfully smooth.

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There are many different things you can frame during your “launch,” like:

- **A funny ice breaker**
  - There’s nothing more comforting than a roaring belly laugh from the audience to get them to engage and see you as a relatable person.

- **Engaging questions**
  - Getting the audience involved directs their attention to you and gives you the chance to own the crowd with your questions and sharing their answers.

- **A big fat claim**
  - This ties into your overall objective. What will they come out of the presentation with? What can you promise them?

- **Acknowledgements**
  - Whether it’s the host of the event or the people in the seats, it’s nice to share the spotlight with the room.

- **Interactive warm-up exercise**
  - Get people moving so they’re feeling energized and comfortable, ready to listen and engage with your presentation however you need them to.

Whichever tactic you feel is most suitable for setting the stage for your talk, it will help create a strong rapport with the audience and get your talk off to a great start.

When you get the launch right, you’ll find the rest of your talk flows incredibly smoothly.

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STEP 3 : F15 – YOUR POWERFUL OPENING

WATCH VIDEO: https://youtu.be/wbjmMMoZZiQ

Your F15 will help you instantly create connection with the audience.

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STEP 4 : L15 – YOUR STRONG CLOSE

This is how you're going to land your talk so your strategic objectives are met, you finish on time and your audience remembers you.

Just like in flying, a great takeoff is completely useless if the flight ends with a crash landing. But if you have your ending planned out in advance, it becomes easy to finish your talk gracefully and leave your audience with exactly what you wanted.

How many times have you been at a presentation and the speaker has clearly gone over their time? Your stomach is gurgling because lunch has long since gone and you're waiting for the doors to open for a bathroom break. It feels like the speaker is eating your time away. It's the worst.

One of the main things to keep in mind as a presenter is to finish on time. This is so important not only for the audience's attention span, but mostly for the organizers who hold the decision of whether or not to book you again.

Having your ending planned in advance means you can relax during the body of your talk, because when you approach the end of your time slot, you just need to transition into your planned ending. You will be able to leave the audience with the final thoughts you intended and you will be able to confidently finish on time.

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Having your ending planned in advance means you can relax during the body of your talk.

Here are some strategies to creating a memorable (and timely) ending:

- **A powerful story**
  - When people's emotions are involved, they won't forget. Use a story that will pull the heart strings and tie into your message, making it memorable and thoughtful.

- **A memorable quote**
  - Tip: if you're sharing it from the screen, turn to face the screen to read it, because where your attention goes, the audience's attention will go.

- **A clear call to action**
  - What do you want the audience to do? And how should they do it? Give clear instructions to make it easy for them to follow through.

- **A solid closing sentence**
  - This could be a tagline or a conclusion. Something to tie it all into a pretty one-line bow.

- **A summary**
  - This is especially important if you have been teaching a lot of different concepts. Give the audience a recap of what they learned.

By using these tactics and carefully planning your ending, you can ensure you will never be the speaker awkwardly trying to end your talk or, worse, going over time. Instead, you will be the speaker who leaves the audience feeling great and makes a lasting impression. It will also make you look like a seasoned pro.

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STEP 4 : L15 – YOUR STRONG CLOSE

WATCH VIDEO: https://youtu.be/bjbhQrPRT_k

Your L15 will help you create a memorable ending worthy of a standing ovation.

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STEP 5 : USING A SPEECH MAP

You know your desired outcome, you've picked your stories, you know your launch and landing route. Now you need to put it all together. This is where a speech map, or a mind map, of your planned speech comes into play.

A traditional script or written-out notes are not the ideal way to document your talk, because most speakers end up just reading from their script (which the audience notices). Or if they lose their place, it becomes difficult to find it again. Or when something goes wrong in the middle of their talk, they can't adapt, because the whole talk is tied to a script.

A speech map helps avoid all this. You won't sound like you're reading a script, because you're not. The speech map is just there to remind you which stories you were going to tell and what points you were going to make, but you're still telling the stories fresh from your heart. If you lose your place, you can easily find it again with just a quick glance, so the audience never even notices. And if something goes wrong and you have to extend or shorten your talk, you can easily do so by simply telling more-detailed or less-detailed versions of your stories; no need to re-write the whole script.

The bonus is, by getting clear on the points you want to make within your speech map, you'll find you may be able to swap different stories in and out to make the same points. This means that not only have you created one talk, you've actually created a talk that can be customized for a specific audience and adjusted to fit a particular time slot. You can even share the same message with the same points, so you can deliver the exact same information, but give a brand new talk every time.

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A speech map is a great tool for planning your speech.

A speech map is a great tool for planning your speech. It gives you a system of notes to bring with you on stage so you don't have to worry about getting off track but you are not tied to a script. It gives you consistency by making sure you cover the information and make the points you intended, while giving you the flexibility to adapt your speech for the audience and even to adapt on the fly to any unexpected events during the talk.

Try completing your own speech map below and watch your next talk come to life.

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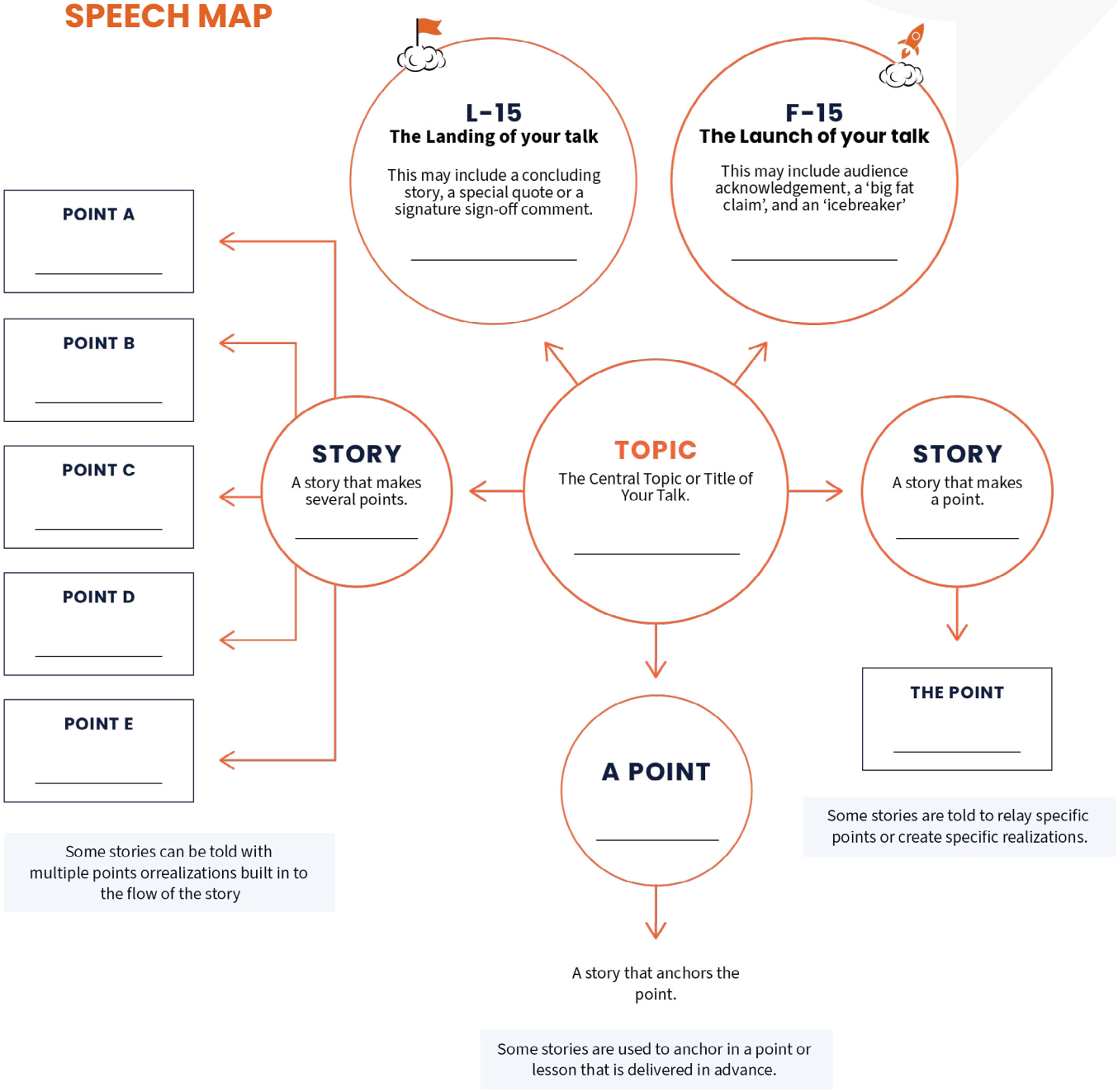
STEP 5 : USING A SPEECH MAP

WATCH VIDEO: https://youtu.be/rnRmBfy44Q8

Put it all together in an organized way by using a Speech Map and Point Flow.

SPEECH MAP



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STEP 5 : USING A SPEECH MAP

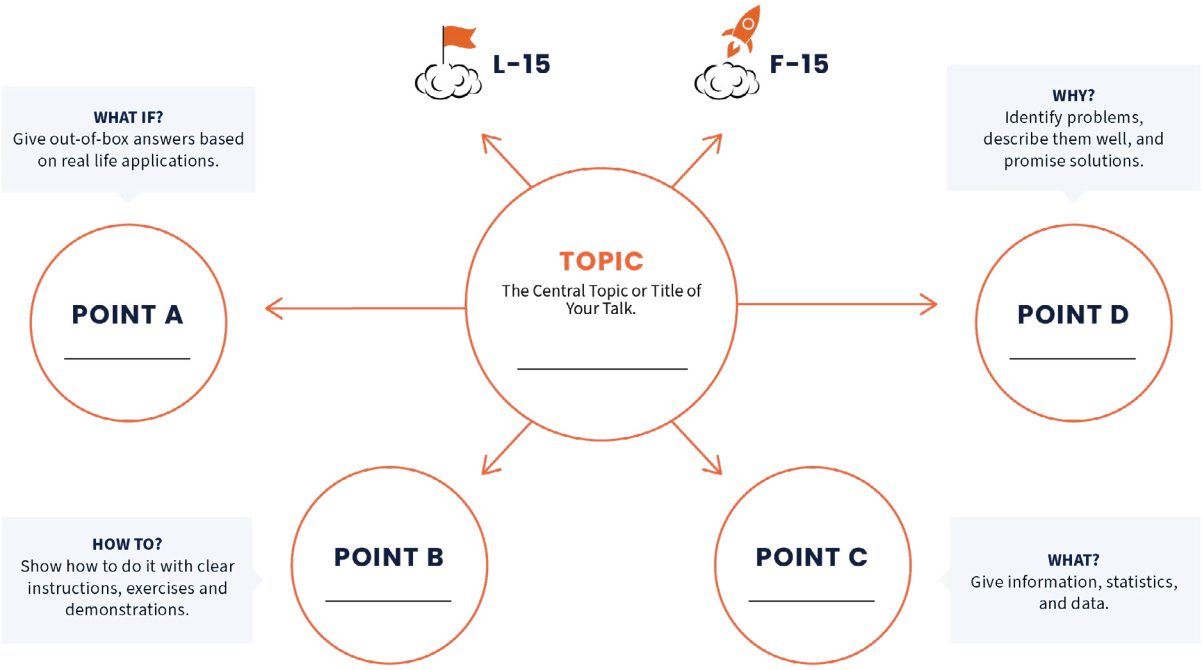
WATCH VIDEO: https://youtu.be/rnRmBfy44Q8

Put it all together in an organized way by using a Speech Map and Point Flow.

SPEECH MAP

Point Flow - Points you want to make

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____



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CONCLUSION

If you really want to have an impact, deliver compelling talks, continue to get booked and have your message delivered to audiences everywhere, you have to be a professional about it. Part of being professional means having a well-tuned system for creating talks you can deliver with consistency and clarity. We hope this guide has given you a solid foundation on which to build a system that works for you and takes your talks to the next level.

We encourage you to take what you have learned in this guide and apply it to your own creative process. The process of creating a truly world-class talk is as unique as the speakers themselves. As a result, these steps are not intended to be a definitive guide, but rather to give you a foundation from which to build your own process of developing your talks. What is truly important is that you have some kind of system that turns creating a talk from being a long, laborious, and exhausting process, to being light hearted, fun, easy and FAST. Speaking is fun and creating your talks should be too!

Having a great method for creating a talk is one piece of the vast puzzle of becoming a world-class speaker, but there is a whole lot more to it than that. Here are some of the other things we think you should have along your speaking journey:

- Passion
- Perseverance
- A positive mindset
- The ability to embrace your fear
- The courage to take the first step again and again
- A commitment to learn and study the craft of speaking
- A desire to share your story
- The authenticity to connect with others
- Training, practice and a community
- A willingness to invest in the training, the coaching, the mentoring and, most importantly, the time it takes to build your skills

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POWERFUL NEXT STEPS

The path to becoming a world-class speaker can be long and complex, but we want to make it as fast and simple as possible for you.

That's why we've developed our Successful Speaking Strategies program. A video-based online program that will take the mystery out of public speaking and put you on the fast track to becoming a world-class communicator.

With over 5 hours of comprehensive video training, supplemented by practical workbooks, you will discover the most important speaking strategies you need to improve your communication skills.

In this program, you will learn how to:

- Create genuine attraction and authority as a speaker
- Use your stories to make a lasting impact on your audience
- Turn your life's stories into powerful marketing tools
- Easily break the ice with any audience
- Overcome the fear of public speaking
- Avoid the biggest and most common mistakes whenever you speak to an audience
- Use speaking to promote your business, products or services
- Effortlessly give a talk without any notes or slides
- And so much more!

ARE YOU READY TO MAKE A TRUE IMPACT WITH YOUR STORY?

Click to Access Successful Speaking Strategies now!

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